



always lived only in one room though you were entitled to a secretary's bungalow. But when you became President, you occupied the best real estate the country has. Did that impact your thinking?

A. Wherever I go, finally a man like me can live only in one room. I made all the other rooms in the Rashtrapati Bhavan operational and functional. For example, in one of them I set up a multimedia studio where I could communicate with anybody in India and abroad. Recently, I spoke to the California Institute of Technology and interacted with them from here. I also had a technology interface centre. So like this, all rooms were made functional.

Q. Would you want a revision of the powers of the President? Do you think the President should play a greater role than what he or she is playing at present?

A. The Constitution has withstood the test of time for over 50 years. As far as I am concerned, I didn't find any impediments in my way of working.

Q. Do you think the President can play a greater role?

the issue and whatever other information I needed was electronically transmitted to me. Based on that I took a decision. If I was present in India, I would have sent back the file (for more details). In place of that I electronically got a lot of information. I asked certain questions and the prime minister discussed it with me twice. And then the relevant papers were transmitted to me electronically. Then only I took a decision.

Q. You took a principled stand over the office-of-profit issue by sending the bill back. Were you disappointed by the Government's response?

A. Regarding the Office of Profit Bill, I had to return it to Parliament for the first time. Naturally, they had to debate and discuss it in Parliament. It had created the necessary impact.

Q. What impact did it have?

A. They appointed a committee—that was the Government's assurance. Though it still has to submit the report.

Q. You have worked with two prime ministers—Atal Bihari Vajpayee and now Manmohan Singh. What would you say are the

“I took the decision on BIHAR after speaking to the PM twice and getting the relevant papers sent to MOSCOW where I was then.”

A. Yes, yes. What he thinks, he wants to do, he can do. If he thinks big, he can do it. The post doesn't restrict the person at all. If the President has vision, he can propagate it and nobody can prevent that. In fact, the nation will welcome it. I addressed the media, both print and television, so many times directly and the Government did not say anything.

Q. Do you have any regrets? Would you consider the decision to dissolve the Bihar Assembly in 2005 as something that you would have acted differently on?

A. I have no regrets. At that time, I was in Russia and I took the decision there. Wherever I go, I am electronically connected to my office, whether in India or abroad. I had detailed discussions with the prime minister on

differences between the two? How would you describe your relations with them?

A. Each one had a unique core competence and also they had developed certain ways of decision-making. Both of them were concerned about accelerated national development. I had an excellent relationship with both the prime ministers and enjoyed working with them.

Q. But in terms of style, how would you describe them?

A. Both the prime ministers had a unique style and were the thinking type. They were men of few words but were action-oriented.

Q. As President, there were many requests for clemency for death penalties pending with you, including that of the main accused in the